

Tennessee Comprehensive Assessment Program

TCAP

English Language Arts Grade 6 Test Practice



Read the passages and answer the questions that follow. Then respond to the writing prompt.

Passage 1

Excerpt from “To Remember Something New: Exercise!”

by Laura Sanders

- 1 Here’s another reason to get off the couch and start working up a sweat. Time the exercise right and you could boost your ability to remember something new. That’s the finding of a new study.
- 2 But it all comes down to timing. To lock up the new information, start burning those calories roughly four hours after you took in the new information. That’s according to researchers at an institute on brain, cognition and behavior. It’s at Radboud University’s Medical Center, in Nijmegen, the Netherlands. Eelco van Dongen and his colleagues shared their new findings in *Current Biology*.
- 3 This precisely timed memory trick comes from tests with 72 people. Each learned the location of 90 objects on a computer screen. Afterward, some of the recruits watched relaxing nature videos. Others worked up a sweat on stationary bikes, alternating between hard and easy pedaling for 35 minutes. Their workouts came either soon after the cram session or four hours later.
- 4 Two days later they were tested again. Those who remembered the objects’ sites best were the people who had waited four hours after their learning session before pedaling away. Among those who remembered sites correctly, the four-hour delay before biking also led to more consistent activity in an area important for memory. It’s known as the hippocampus. The consistent activity here suggests that the memories had been strong, the scientists say.
- 5 Van Dongen’s team does not yet know how exercise works its memory magic. They do, however, have a guess. Aerobic exercise sparks the creation of several important chemicals in the brain. One is a protein known as BDNF. The other is dopamine (DO-puh-meen). It can help relay messages between nerve cells. These two molecules may help solidify memories by rewiring links between brain cells, the researchers suspect.

Excerpt from “To Remember Something New: Exercise!” by Laura Sanders, from *Science News for Students*, July 29, 2016. Copyright © 2016, Society for Science and the Public. Used by permission of the publisher via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2

Excerpt from “Mistakes: A key to learning”

Scientists discover that we remember our errors, which is a good thing

by Alison Pearce Stevens

- 6 Attempting a new task almost always involves trial and error. We pay attention to those errors, a new study shows. Our brains store memories of past blunders. We then use those memories to improve how well we do in future attempts, a new study finds.
- 7 David Herzfeld discovered this newly identified type of memory. As a biomedical engineer at Johns Hopkins University School of Medicine in Baltimore, Md., he combines engineering and technology to aid public health.
- 8 In the new study, Herzfeld recruited people to play a simple video game. Participants were asked to move a cursor across a screen by manipulating a robotic arm. Critically, the robotic arm and the person’s hand were shielded from the player’s view. Participants instead had to focus on a computer screen. There, they saw a dot and a target. Their goal was to move the dot to the target.
- 9 That sounds easy enough. But the researchers could impose some challenges along the way. For instance, in one trial, participants had to move the robotic arm straight forward. But in some cases, the cursor moved a little more than the arm did. Other times, the cursor moved a little less. When those errors occurred in the same direction each time, participants remembered them. With each new attempt, the test participants corrected their movements a bit. And this slowly improved their ability to hit the target. But when those errors kept switching direction — being a little too far, then not far enough — participants ignored them.
- 10 Herzfeld likens this to playing a game of darts. “The first dart you throw is a little too low,” he says. When you try to correct on your next throw, it lands high. “You’ve over-corrected,” he explains. By doing so, you have made a mistake in a different direction. If such mistakes happen over and over, your brain learns to ignore them. And it stops trying to correct for them.
- 11 But later in the game, you might throw the dart too low again. Herzfeld wanted to know what would happen then — could the brain recall the earlier low throw and correct the error?

- 12 To find out whether our brains really do “save” errors — remembering them for another time when they might prove useful — Herzfeld carried out a second set of tests. Here, when players moved the robotic arm forward, it rotated 30 degrees (one-twelfth of a circle, or the distance from one hour’s numeral to the next on a clock). One group experienced a clockwise rotation. The others got a counterclockwise rotation. For both groups, this was followed by a second phase with no rotation — the arm moved straight forward. In the third phase of the experiment, the arm rotated counterclockwise for both groups.
- 13 Herzfeld found that both groups hit the target faster during the last set of counterclockwise rotations. He expected this for the first group. That’s because they had experienced the same rotation in phase one. And they had “saved” memories of their errors, now using them to make the proper corrections.
- 14 The surprise was that the other group — the one that had the opposite rotation in phase one — also improved. Herzfeld calls this an example of “meta-learning.” That happens when we remember errors from one situation and apply them to a different one.
- 15 In this case, the people playing the game remembered the clockwise rotation from phase one. When the robotic arm stopped rotating, they made new errors by trying to correct for a rotation that was no longer there. When the direction of rotation changed again, in phase three, participants applied what they had learned in the first two sets of tests. They quickly adjusted, using what they learned earlier about rotation to deal with the new direction.
- 16 That switch from phase one to phase two was an important part of the learning process, Herzfeld found. When participants experienced a long pause between those two phases, they did not show the same recall of past errors. During the delay, the participants forgot what they had learned. His team’s study was published August 14 in Science.
- 17 It’s an exciting finding, says Farrel Robinson. He’s a neuroscientist at the University of Washington in Seattle and not involved in the research. This study is the first to show that the history of mistakes is what matters in motor learning, he says. Motor learning is the type that has to do with body movements. The new data also show that history determines whether our brains will learn from past errors when building new skills.
- 18 So the next time you set out to try a new activity, be bold. Make mistakes. They just may help you learn faster.

Excerpt from “Mistakes: A key to learning” by Alison Pearce Stevens, from Science News for Students, September 5, 2014. Copyright © 2014, Society for Science and the Public. Used by permission of the publisher via Copyright Clearance Center.

00. What is the meaning of the word consistent as it is used in paragraph 4?

- A.** basic
- B.** steady
- C.** noticeable
- D.** appropriate

- 00.** According to van Dongen’s study in Passage 1, which factor **most** affected whether exercising after studying improved people’s memories?
- A.** how long they exercised
 - B.** how intensely they exercised
 - C.** how much they liked to exercise
 - D.** how long they waited to exercise

00. Which word would **best** replace the word participants in paragraph 8?

- A.** researchers
- B.** students
- C.** scientists
- D.** players

00. Writing Prompt

You have just read two studies about improving learning. Write an informational essay explaining how you could use the information in both passages to learn something new.

Manage your time carefully so that you can

- plan your essay and do some prewriting using your scratch paper.
- write your response to the writing prompt in the space provided.

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Excerpt from “A Boy Your Age”

by Rebecca Stead

The following passage is written from the viewpoint of an adolescent boy named Georges, who is adjusting to changes in his life.

- 1 On Sunday morning I stand in the lobby of our apartment building, watching the movers come in and out. Dad says I’m holding the door, but the door is actually propped open with a scratched-up wooden triangle that reminds me of the blocks area in pre-K. What I’m really doing is looking down at that wedge of wood and thinking about how I used to make these super-long car ramps with Jason, and how Jason dresses like a skateboarder now. . . .
- 2 I lean past the lobby door so I can see up and down the empty sidewalk. It’s super-bright out, and the trees make cool shadows on the pavement.
- 3 Dad’s in the moving truck, making sure the furniture comes out in a certain order. I’m guessing he’s being about as helpful as I am, standing guard over my wooden wedge.
- 4 I’m hearing a sound. It’s a funny, high-pitched buzzing that I think maybe I’ve *been* hearing for a while, without noticing. There should be a word for that, when you hear something and simultaneously realize that it’s been swimming around in your brain for five minutes without your permission.
- 5 I glance around to see what’s buzzing, first at the ancient yellow chandelier above my head, then at the shiny silver intercom on the wall. It’s the kind with a keypad and a little camera that lets the people in their apartments see who’s in the lobby before deciding whether to let them in. Dad has already shown me how the whole thing works.
- 6 I take a step toward the intercom, and the buzzing stops.
- 7 I go back to thinking about Jason, who was my every-day-after-school friend until the end of sixth grade, when he went to sleepaway camp for seven weeks and then started sitting at the cool table in September like he’d been there all along.
- 8 All of a sudden there’s a whole lot of noise coming from somewhere right above me, a weird mix of rattling, clicking, and pounding that echoes around the tiled lobby, and then two dogs appear on the landing at the top of the stairs, a giant yellow one and a small dark one. There’s a boy about my size behind the

dogs, holding the twisted leashes in one hand and trying to keep a grip on the banister with the other.

- 9 I flatten myself against the open door, thinking the dogs will pull the boy past me and out the front, but they don't. Instead, they drag him almost in a circle, to a door underneath the stairs. They make the turn so fast that he actually hops on one leg for a few seconds, almost tipping over sideways, like in a cartoon.
- 10 The door under the stairs is closed. The dogs wait in front of it, wiggling and wagging, while the boy, not once looking at me, struggles to get a huge ring of keys out of his front jeans pocket. He picks a key, unlocks the door, and pushes it open. I can see another set of stairs, going down.
- 11 The dogs surge, pulling the boy down the stairs, and the door slams shut behind them. Loudly. And then everything is quiet again.
- 12 I know exactly what Dad would say if he were here. He wouldn't mention the weird stuff — how the dogs ran straight to a mystery door under the stairs, or the kid's enormous key ring.
- 13 Dad would only say, "Look, Georges! A boy your age."

Excerpt from *Liar and Spy* by Rebecca Stead. Copyright © 2012. Used with permission from the publisher via Copyright Clearance Center.

00. What is the meaning of surge in paragraph 11?

- A.** pour out
- B.** rush forward
- C.** fall into
- D.** yank backward

- 00.** The following item has two parts. Answer Part A and then answer Part B.

Part A

How does Georges respond to the arrival of the boy with two dogs?

- A.** He looks up and down the sidewalk to see what the day is like.
- B.** He presses his body against the entrance door to the lobby.
- C.** He suddenly notices noises they had been making for a while.
- D.** He approaches the silver intercom that is near the lobby door.

Part B

Which detail from the passage **best** describes Georges' response from Part A?

- A.** "It's the kind with a keypad and a little camera that lets the people in their apartments see" (paragraph 5)
- B.** "I go back to thinking about Jason, who was my every-day-after-school friend until the end of sixth grade" (paragraph 7)
- C.** "All of a sudden there's a whole lot of noise coming from somewhere right above me, a weird mix of rattling, clicking" (paragraph 8)
- D.** "I flatten myself against the open door, thinking the dogs will pull the boy past me and out the front" (paragraph 9)

00. Read the sentences from paragraph 13.

Dad would only say, “Look, Georges! A boy your age.”

What is **most likely** the reason Georges’ father would make this statement?

- A.** He knows Georges would rather be alone than hang out with friends.
- B.** He does not like the friends Georges currently has.
- C.** He knows Georges has not had any close friendships since Jason.
- D.** He worries that most of Georges’ friends are older than he is.

- 00.** What is **most likely** the purpose of paragraphs 1 and 7?
- A.** They establish the mood that Georges is in and the loneliness he feels.
 - B.** They explain why Georges moved into a new apartment building with his dad.
 - C.** They establish details about the setting and how it is important in the story.
 - D.** They suggest that Georges is bored standing in the lobby of the apartment building.

00. The following item has two parts. Answer Part A and then answer Part B.

Part A

Which sentence **best** expresses a theme of the passage?

- A.** Moving to a new place is sad without having any friends to talk to about it.
- B.** When moving into a new home, it is important to understand your surroundings.
- C.** Changing situations in life can make people think about what has been lost or left behind.
- D.** Having an open mind and staying curious about a new place help people to feel at home.

Part B

How does the author develop this theme?

- A.** by making Georges notice new sounds around him
- B.** by having Georges watch the boy with the dogs
- C.** by showing Georges' relationship with his father
- D.** by having Georges remember his former friend

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Excerpt from *Life at the Top*

by Dan Risch

- 1 Upon this high plateau slung between the world's tallest mountains thrive the nomads of Tibet. Isolated from conveniences such as indoor plumbing, sturdy warm housing, and electricity, they've adapted to living in one of Earth's harshest environments. They live in step with the environment. Moreover, scientists are discovering that even Tibetans' bodies have adapted to living at the world's edge.
- 2 The land's extremes arise from the mountains surrounding the plateau. Tibetan nomads live where trees can't grow, rivers don't exist, and each breath of air has much less oxygen than a breath taken at sea level.
- 3 Breathing less oxygen stresses people. Called high altitude hypoxia (hi-POX-ee-uh), it causes headaches, fatigue, nausea, and loss of appetite. Someone experiencing hypoxia has lost their balance, but not in the sense of tripping. Their body has lost homeostasis.
- 4 Homeostasis (rhymes with Romeo-stay-sis) means keeping fluids within the body in balance. The high elevation of Tibet disrupts a person's homeostasis. Yet, Tibetans live healthy lives. Unique among all the people of the world (except for people living on the Ethiopian Plateau or in the Andes Mountains), Tibetans have developed adaptations to maintain homeostasis. Scientists refer to adaptations as cultural or physiological¹. Tibetans use both.
- 5 Dr. Cynthia Beall studies Tibetans' high altitude adaptations. She has lived with Tibet's yak, goat, and sheep herding nomads. She admires what she believes is the key to their cultural adaptations: living in harmony with nature.
- 6 She says that cold is a constant on the plateau. Deep winter temperatures fall to 30° below zero F. Summer temperatures rise to the 70s, in direct sunlight. In response to the cold, Tibetans stay outside when the sun shines. Their clothing and tent homes borrow their sheep's and yaks' natural protections against cold. They wear bathrobe-like coats with leather outside to repel wind and hail with fleece inside for insulation.
- 7 Seasonal shifts guide Tibetan herd management and food use. They move their herds to allow . . . animals to eat the richest grasses when producing milk for newborn kids and lambs. They collect milk for themselves, too. They make food to store for later use. Buttermilk is used first, then yogurt, a favorite food,

¹**physiological:** relating to the processes that keep living things alive

and then butter and hard cheese, which lasts until the next milk-producing season.

- 8 As efficient as these cultural adaptations are, they alone don't allow Tibetans to live healthy lives. Dr. Beall has discovered within the Tibetans' bodies physiological adaptations that promote homeostasis in their high-altitude world.
- 9 First, she found that Tibetans take a lot of breaths to move more oxygen into their bodies. In fact, Tibetans take 75 percent more breaths per minute than someone at sea level.
- 10 But this adaptation still isn't enough to maintain homeostasis while living on the plateau. Dr. Beall recently discovered another physiological adaptation. Tibetans' blood circulates fast. Their blood vessels open very wide. This means that more blood picks up new oxygen from the lungs more frequently. . . .
- 11 Altogether, these cultural and physiological adaptations allow Tibetans to survive life at the top of the world.

Excerpt from *Life at the Top* by Dan Risch. Copyright © 2006, *Faces* Magazine. Used by permission of the publisher via Copyright Clearance Center.

- 00.** What does the author mean when he says the Tibetans “live in step with the environment” in paragraph 1?
- A.** They travel long distances on foot.
 - B.** They travel together as an organized group.
 - C.** They feel closely connected to their surroundings.
 - D.** They claim ownership of the plateau.

- 00.** In which **two** ways does the author **best** develop an important idea about the difficulty of life on the Tibetan Plateau?
- A.** by explaining how the region lacks trees
 - B.** by explaining the lack of oxygen in the air
 - C.** by describing the low winter temperatures
 - D.** by suggesting there is a lack of food sources
 - E.** by describing what kinds of animals live there

00. What is the meaning of repel as it is used in paragraph 6?

- A.** block
- B.** collect
- C.** sense
- D.** turn

- 00.** The following item has two parts. Answer Part A and then answer Part B.

Part A

What is a central idea of paragraphs 6–10?

- A.** Scientists have determined that Tibetans need to find new ways to face the challenges of living in severe conditions.
- B.** Tibetans survive in the severe conditions but the physical damage on their bodies is too great.
- C.** Tibetans can live healthy lives in harsh conditions because their bodies have undergone changes.
- D.** Scientists have learned that Tibetans need to undergo more study to understand what their findings mean for the future.

Part B

Which sentence from the passage **best** supports the correct answer to Part A?

- A.** “In response to the cold, Tibetans stay outside when the sun shines.” (paragraph 6)
- B.** “Seasonal shifts guide Tibetan herd management and food use.” (paragraph 7)
- C.** “First, she found that Tibetans take a lot of breaths to move more oxygen into their bodies.” (paragraph 9)
- D.** “Dr. Beall recently discovered another physiological adaptation.” (paragraph 10)

- 00.** What is the **main** purpose of paragraphs 3 and 4 in the overall structure of the passage?
- A.** They describe the health and physical challenges the Tibetan nomads face on the Tibetan Plateau.
 - B.** They introduce an important feature that allows Tibetan nomads to live on the Tibetan Plateau.
 - C.** They explain the physical complaints that scientists are studying among the Tibetan nomads.
 - D.** They compare the Tibetan nomads to people living in areas with similar environmental conditions.

- 00.** The following item has two parts. Answer Part A and then answer Part B.

Part A

Based on the passage, which sentence shows a central idea about the Tibetans?

- A.** They seem to be satisfied with their situation.
- B.** They want scientists to help them figure out better ways to live.
- C.** They want more modern lifestyles than what they currently have.
- D.** They have figured out how to survive in less than ideal conditions.

Part B

Which **two** details **best** support the correct answer to Part A?

- A.** "Isolated from conveniences" (paragraph 1)
- B.** "less oxygen stresses people" (paragraph 3)
- C.** "Unique among all the people of the world" (paragraph 4)
- D.** "living in harmony with nature" (paragraph 5)
- E.** "stay outside when the sun shines" (paragraph 6)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Excerpt from *Western Wind*

by Paula Fox

In the following passage, the youngest member of the Benedict family, Elizabeth, reflects on her relationship with the oldest member of the Benedict family, Gran.

- 1 Ten years ago, Gran started renting the cottage on the island during July and August. It was a good place for a painter, she said. None of the Benedicts had visited her there. It was too hard to get to, Gran insisted, and it certainly wasn't big enough for four people. "We'd go mad!" she'd said.
- 2 "Why does she need two places at her age?" Elizabeth heard her father ask her mom. "In some ways, she's as extravagant as an adolescent."
- 3 "She's a painter," her mother had replied. "They never grow older than the age at which they began to paint."
- 4 It wasn't, Elizabeth knew, that her mother didn't care for her mother-in-law. But there was a kind of hesitation in her feeling for Gran, like a hiccup before you get out a word.
- 5 Elizabeth could hear that hesitation in the way her mother laughed, always a few seconds late, at something odd or comical Gran said. And she could see it when Gran came through the front door of their farmhouse north of Boston at Christmas, carrying her old morocco leather suitcase in one hand and a shopping bag of gifts in the other. Mom would nearly always wait a minute too long to hug her so that Gran, after a brief pause, would walk past her into the living room. Then she might say something like "I'm glad to see you haven't blocked up the fireplace yet" or "I hope you don't pull the shades down on these shorter days. The light is so smoky and mysterious. These folk around here tend to pull down their shades at five P.M., and they'll do it on the last day of the world."
- 6 Elizabeth could see her mother's mouth tighten at the very moment she was trying to smile.
- 7 Elizabeth understood how irritating Gran could be, yet she knew that her mother admired her. Elizabeth did, too. Though Gran didn't pay much attention to her as a rule, and she could be sharp.
- 8 One Thanksgiving, she'd told Elizabeth that if she described something as *cool* once more, she'd have her arrested for melting down the English language. . . .

- 9 That was how it often went between the young Benedicts and the old Benedict. Gran would say something cutting, then smile or laugh outright. But when she was around, there was an edge to the days, a kind of nervy liveliness. Even Elizabeth's father, a rather silent man, would grow talkative, arguing with Gran about painters he thought were better than she did, or about the government, which he thought worse than she did, and about a dozen other things. The hundred-year-old conversation, Elizabeth called it in her mind.
- 10 Now and then, on a rainy day, Elizabeth would go up to the attic that Gran had used for a studio when she had lived in the farmhouse. There were two old steamer trunks there, a battered easel near the big north-facing window, and a few canvasses propped against an unfinished wall. Some pencil sketches were still tacked to a rickety screen. One was of Elizabeth as a tiny infant. At times she thought it looked like her, but at other times it could have been any infant in the world.
- 11 There was one finished painting among the canvasses. It was a winter landscape. Two crows sat on a fence that slanted across snow-covered corn stubble in a long field that reached to the horizon. Elizabeth liked that painting and told Gran so.
- 12 "It looks just like what I see out the window in winter," she'd said.
- 13 "Do you only like what you can recognize?" Gran asked her. She seemed really curious.
- 14 "How can I like something I can't recognize?" Elizabeth asked after thinking a moment.
- 15 "Why do you have to like everything?" Gran asked.
- 16 Elizabeth was speechless.
- 17 "I mean," Gran went on in an unusually gentle voice, "can't you just be interested in things? And forget about liking?"
- 18 She'd brought Elizabeth a small pearl ring one Christmas. She'd found it in a shop on a shabby boulevard in Paris.
- 19 "One of those places you can't imagine surviving from one week to another, like some of the little stores you see here in town. The owner had a few rings in the window, a cameo or two, a boring gold chain, and the ring I got you. The shop was no bigger than a closet, but when I went inside I saw that the walls were covered with photographs of a beautiful chestnut racehorse. It turned out the man owned that horse. It had won two races for him. Suzerain was its name, and it was what he most loved in the world. He kept the shop to support the

horse, not himself. I found out he was originally from Algiers. Your little ring is connected to all of that, Elizabeth. Do you know where Algiers is?"

20 "Sort of," Elizabeth had replied.

21 "'Sort of' won't do for geography," Gran said. So very soon, she'd found an atlas in the house and shown Elizabeth just where Algiers was. . . .

Excerpt from *Western Wind* by Paula Fox. Copyright © 1993. Published by Orchard Books.

00. What does the word irritating mean as it is used in paragraph 7?

- A.** outgoing
- B.** alarming
- C.** bothersome
- D.** foolish

- 00.** How is Gran's response to upsetting Elizabeth in paragraph 17 different from how she responds to upsetting other family members? Select **two** answers.
- A.** She changes her voice to use a more gentle tone.
 - B.** She has to have the last word in the matter.
 - C.** She quickly changes the topic of conversation.
 - D.** She continues to push Elizabeth to get a reaction.
 - E.** She attempts to explain to Elizabeth what she really means.

- 00.** Which **two** sentences would **best** be included in a summary of the passage?
- A.** Gran refuses to allow family to visit the summer cottage.
 - B.** Elizabeth's father becomes different when Gran is present.
 - C.** Gran's strong opinions have always made it difficult for family members to get along with her.
 - D.** At one time, Gran utilized the attic in the farmhouse as an art studio.
 - E.** Through her actions, Gran shows her affection for Elizabeth.

- 00.** Which detail **best** helps the reader infer that Gran can make people feel uncomfortable?
- A.** ““Why does she need two places at her age?’ Elizabeth heard her father ask her mom.” (paragraph 2)
 - B.** “It wasn’t, Elizabeth knew, that her mother didn’t care for her mother-in-law.” (paragraph 4)
 - C.** “Elizabeth could see her mother’s mouth tighten at the very moment she was trying to smile.” (paragraph 6)
 - D.** “Elizabeth understood how irritating Gran could be, yet she knew that her mother admired her.” (paragraph 7)

00. Why does the author **most likely** include Gran’s vivid description of the shop in paragraph 19? Select **two** answers.

- A.** to show that Elizabeth is special to Gran
- B.** to contrast the personalities of Gran and Elizabeth
- C.** to reveal the sentimental value of the gift from Gran
- D.** to show that Gran is impulsive when making purchases
- E.** to show that Gran enjoys traveling abroad alone

00. The following item has two parts. Answer Part A and then answer Part B.

Part A

How does Elizabeth's mother **most likely** feel about Gran?

- A.** She is frustrated by Gran but accepts her as family.
- B.** She wishes her relationship with Gran were better.
- C.** She is envious of Gran for her achievements.
- D.** She realizes she has a lot in common with Gran.

Part B

Which **two** paragraphs **best** support the correct answer to Part A?

- A.** paragraph 3
- B.** paragraph 4
- C.** paragraph 5
- D.** paragraph 6
- E.** paragraph 7

There are five underlined parts in the passage. Some underlined parts may contain errors to be corrected, or they may need to be changed for better wording. If a change is needed, select the correct replacement. If no change is needed, select “No change.” For other underlined parts, you may only need to answer a question about the underlined word or phrase.

Sasha’s head was pounding. Her teacher had assigned a creative writing topic, a narrative describing an embarrassing moment, and Sasha was stumped. Though she was proud of her writing ability, her mind remained blank, and now she was starting to panic. The other students in the room were not only writing vigorously but also were entertaining themselves. Sasha could hear occasional giggles and laughter coming from them as they remembered some funny past experiences. Her friend Olivia was grinning happily but she was anxious to actually read her finished story to the class.

“Why can’t I think of anything,” Sasha mumbled to herself.

Just then, Sasha overheard Carter telling Paul about the first time he rode a horse. While trying to mount the horse, he sailed over the saddle, made it to the other side, and landed on the soft grass. Their laughter made Sasha smile. She had ridden horses, too. Suddenly her topic came to her.

Last summer at her uncle’s farm, she had entered the corral to visit her favorite horse. However, she forgot to close the gate behind her. All six horses turned and cantered out of the corral and down the gravel road. Her uncle, thank goodness, laughed heartily and shouted, “No worries!” He charged off on its own horse to bring the escaped horses back. Sasha could feel her face turning red. She was soon able to laugh at herself when she heard her aunt’s laughter coming from the house.

00. Which change, if any, is needed to the underlined text?

happily but

- A.** happily, but,
- B.** happily, but
- C.** happily but,
- D.** No change

00. Which change, if any, is needed to the underlined text?

“Why can’t I think of anything,” Sasha mumbled to herself.

- A.** “Why can’t I think of anything, Sasha mumbled to herself?”
- B.** “Why can’t I think of anything?” Sasha mumbled to herself.
- C.** “Why can’t I think of anything”? Sasha mumbled to herself.
- D.** No change

00. Which change, if any, is needed to the underlined text?

he sailed over the saddle, made it to the other side, and landed on the soft grass.

- A.** he sailed over the saddle, made it to the other side, and landed, on the soft grass.
- B.** he sailed over the saddle, made it to the other side, and, landed on the soft grass.
- C.** he sailed over the saddle, made it to the other side and, landed on the soft grass.
- D.** No change

00. Which change, if any, is needed to the underlined text?

its

- A.** our
- B.** their
- C.** his
- D.** No change

00. Which change, if any, is needed to the underlined text?

coming

- A.** come
- B.** came
- C.** had come
- D.** No change

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

from “First Lady of Wildflowers”

by Patricia Nikolina Clark



Car on winding road lined by Texas bluebonnets

- 1 Wildflowers in a mountain meadow are a gift of nature. But what about those wildflowers blooming along busy highways? Well, nature had a helper.
- 2 As the wife of our thirty-sixth President, Lyndon B. Johnson, Claudia Alta “Lady Bird” Johnson wanted beauty to be a national priority. “Americans spend a lot of time traveling the highways,” said the former First Lady. “That’s why it’s so important to make them as beautiful as possible.”
- 3 Lady Bird loved wildflowers. As a little girl growing up in “deep east Texas,” wildflowers helped her get through lonely times. . . . Her older brothers were away at school, so Lady Bird turned to nature for company.
- 4 “Nature was my friend and my teacher,” she said. “It was a joy to me, and it’s never failed me.”
- 5 Lady Bird loved to roam the woods. With the crush of pine needles under her feet and the wind whispering overhead, she would search for the wild violets and daffodils of spring. Then, in her own little ceremony, she would crown the first one “the queen.” Though she was alone, she wasn’t lonely; wildflowers were her playmates.
- 6 After high school, Lady Bird left home for the University of Texas in Austin. Again she found joy in nature—in the vast quantities of Texas bluebonnets that

covered the fields and roadsides of the Hill Country. She delighted in going on picnics and explorations with friends.

7 It was there that Lady Bird met and fell in love with a handsome young congressional aide named Lyndon Baines Johnson. He proposed to her on their first date.

8 Lady Bird was in Dallas, Texas, with her husband on November 22, 1963, when President John F. Kennedy was assassinated. Shortly after that terrible tragedy, Vice-President Johnson became President, and Lady Bird Johnson became First Lady of the land she loved so much.

9 The job of the First Lady is not defined in the Constitution. Each First Lady has to create that role for herself. Lady Bird wasn't at all sure what her own role should be.

10 “The whole country selects the President,” Lady Bird said, “but only one man selects the First Lady—and it is highly unlikely that he was thinking of her as First Lady when he proposed!”

11 One day in May of 1964, Lady Bird was listening to her husband speak at the University of Michigan. He talked about the gradual disappearance of “America the Beautiful” due to land development and pollution. “And once man can no longer walk with beauty and wonder at nature,” he said, “his spirit will wither and his sustenance be wasted.”

12 Listening to his words, Lady Bird remembered her childhood joy of playing in the woods with the wildflowers. She remembered how nature had been her friend. An idea began to form in her mind: As First Lady, she could do something to help keep America beautiful. She could make sure that children would always know the joy of wildflowers.

13 Lady Bird went right to work. She persuaded the President to propose a Highway Beautification Act that provided controls for billboards and junkyards along highways and allocated money to landscape roadsides. The act was passed in 1965.

14 Then the First Lady started visiting wilderness areas. Reporters and photographers followed as she rafted down the Rio Grande and hiked in the Redwood National Forest. She wanted Americans to wake up to the beauty of their heritage—to see what would be lost if they didn't act to preserve it.

15 “Wherever I go in America,” said Lady Bird, “I like it when the land speaks its own language in its own regional accent. Texas should look like Texas, and Mississippi like Mississippi.” She realized that each part of the country has its own flavor—and its own native wildflowers.

- 16 Lady Bird pointed out that many wildflowers, like people, were immigrants. “They crossed the nation on the wheels of covered wagons, on the hooves of Spanish horses, perhaps even in the pockets of children.”
- 17 In 1969 a new President took office, and the Johnsons moved back to Texas. But Lady Bird didn’t stop preaching about roadside beautification. Instead, she started the *Lady Bird Johnson Award for Highway Beautification*, which gave prizes each year to maintenance crews who planted and cared for wildflowers and native plants along the Texas roadways. Today more than a million miles of Texas roadways are edged with wildflowers.
- 18 On her seventieth birthday, in 1982, Lady Bird started the National Wildflower Research Center (now called the Lady Bird Johnson Wildflower Center) in Austin, Texas. The center encourages people to landscape with native plants and wildflowers. Information is given out regarding which plants are appropriate for planting in each region of the United States, along with advice on how to grow them.
- 19 But Lady Bird’s influence had an even farther-reaching effect. In 1987 Texas Senator Lloyd Bentsen persuaded Congress to pass a bill requiring states to use part of their highway landscaping money to plant native wildflowers along their roadways.
- 20 Lady Bird is no longer First Lady of the land, but she is certainly our First Lady of wildflowers. She . . . made us see that highways can be beautiful. And she is the reason why wildflowers now brighten our travels through almost every state.

From “First Lady of Wildflowers” by Patricia Nikolina Clark from HIGHLIGHTS FOR CHILDREN, August 2000. Used by permission of Highlights for Children, Inc. All rights reserved.

- 00.** What is the meaning of the phrase “wind whispering overhead” as it is used in paragraph 5?
- A.** a gentle noise
 - B.** an unusual sound
 - C.** a tone that is difficult to hear
 - D.** a warning of an upcoming storm

- 00.** What is the author's purpose for writing this passage?
- A.** to explain the inspiration behind a former First Lady's project
 - B.** to detail America's fascination with highway travel
 - C.** to demonstrate the importance of the First Lady's role in America
 - D.** to describe the transitions that occurred during President Johnson's time in office

- 00.** Which **two** statements **best** show how the author illustrates Lady Bird's appreciation for nature in paragraphs 5 and 6?
- A.** by mentioning that flowers were Lady Bird's childhood playmates
 - B.** by explaining how Lady Bird first saw bluebonnets when she moved to Austin
 - C.** by showing that Lady Bird knew the names of plants in different parts of Texas
 - D.** by revealing that Lady Bird made use of the roadsides in the Hill Country
 - E.** by listing specific types of flowers Lady Bird enjoyed

- 00.** Which conclusion does paragraph 15 **best** support?
- A.** Texas and Mississippi are very different from each other.
 - B.** Lady Bird valued the uniqueness of each state.
 - C.** Lady Bird enjoyed traveling across America.
 - D.** Native wildflowers are common throughout America.

- 00.** The following item has two parts. Answer Part A and then answer Part B.

Part A

What is a central idea of the passage?

- A.** Texas’s highways look different than the highways in other states.
- B.** Lady Bird objected to natural areas being replaced with unnecessary highways.
- C.** Highways have turned out to be a useful way for people to get from place to place.
- D.** Highways are more beautiful as a result of Lady Bird’s project.

Part B

Which detail from the passage **best** supports the correct answer to Part A?

- A.** “‘Americans spend a lot of time traveling the highways,’ said the former First Lady.” (paragraph 2)
- B.** “Again she found joy in nature—in the vast quantities of Texas bluebonnets that covered the fields and roadsides of the Hill Country.” (paragraph 6)
- C.** “She realized that each part of the country has its own flavor—and its own native wildflowers.” (paragraph 15)
- D.** “Today more than a million miles of Texas roadways are edged with wildflowers.” (paragraph 17)

Metadata—English

Passage

Grade	Passage Title	Lexile Level	Word Count
6	from "To Remember Something New: Exercise!"	880L	296
6	from "Mistakes: A key to learning"	890L	780
6	from "A Boy Your Age"	1120L	606
6	from Life at the Top	1020L	498
6	from Western Wind	980L	886
6	A Moment to Remember	830L	245
6	from "First Lady of Wildflowers"	990L	883

Metadata Definitions

Grade	Grade level or Course.
Passage Title	Title of the passage(s) associated with this item.
Lexile Level	Readability level for passage.
Word Count	Count of words in the passage.

Items

Page Number	Grade	Item Type	Key	TN Standards
4	6	MC	B	6.L.VAU.4
5	6	MC	D	6.RI.KID.1
6	6	MC	D	6.L.VAU.4
7	6	CR	Scored with Writing Rubric	6.W.TTP.2
10	6	MC	B	6.L.VAU.4
11	6	Composite	B`D	6.RL.KID.3
12	6	MC	C	6.RL.KID.1
13	6	MC	A	6.RL.CS.5
14	6	Composite	C`D	6.RL.KID.2
17	6	MC	C	6.RI.CS.4
18	6	MS	B,C	6.RI.KID.3
19	6	MC	A	6.RI.CS.4
20	6	Composite	C`C	6.RI.KID.2
21	6	MC	B	6.RI.CS.5
22	6	Composite	D`B,E	6.RI.KID.2
26	6	MC	C	6.L.VAU.4
27	6	MS	A,E	6.RL.KID.3

28	6	MS	C,E	6.RL.KID.2
29	6	MC	C	6.RL.KID.1
30	6	MS	A,C	6.RL.KID.3
31	6	Composite	A`C,E	6.RL.KID.1
33	6	MC	B	6.L.CSE.2
34	6	MC	B	6.L.CSE.2
35	6	MC	D	6.L.CSE.2
36	6	MC	C	6.L.CSE.1
37	6	MC	D	6.L.CSE.1
41	6	MC	A	6.L.VAU.4
42	6	MC	A	6.RI.CS.6
43	6	MS	A,E	6.RI.KID.3
44	6	MC	B	6.RI.KID.1
45	6	Composite	D`D	6.RI.KID.2

Metadata Definitions

Grade	Grade level or Course.
Item Type	Indicates the type of item. MC= Multiple Choice, MS = Multiple Select, Composite = MC for Part A, MC or MS for Part B
Key	Correct answer. This may be blank for constructed response items where students write or type their responses.
TN Standards	Primary educational standard assessed.

TNReady Grades 6-8 Informational/Explanatory Rubric

Revised: May 2017

Score	Focus & Organization	Development	Language	Conventions
4	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - contains an effective and relevant introduction. - utilizes effective organizational strategies to create a unified whole and to aid in comprehension. - effectively clarifies relationships among ideas and concepts to create cohesion. - contains an effective and relevant concluding statement or section.	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - utilizes well-chosen, relevant, and sufficient evidence¹ from the stimuli to thoroughly and insightfully develop the topic. - thoroughly and accurately explains and elaborates on the evidence provided, demonstrating a clear, insightful understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.	The writing: - illustrates consistent and sophisticated command of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary² appropriate to the task. - illustrates sophisticated command of syntactic variety for meaning and reader interest. - utilizes sophisticated and varied transitional words and phrases. - effectively establishes and maintains a formal style and an objective tone.	The writing: - demonstrates consistent and sophisticated command of grade-level conventions of standard written English.³ - may contain a few minor errors that do not interfere with meaning.
3	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - contains a relevant introduction. - utilizes adequate organizational strategies to create a mostly unified whole and to aid in comprehension. - clarifies most relationships among ideas and concepts, but there may be some gaps in cohesion. - contains a relevant concluding statement or section.	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - utilizes relevant and sufficient evidence¹ from the stimuli to adequately develop the topic. - adequately and accurately explains and elaborates on the evidence provided, demonstrating a sufficient understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.	The writing: - illustrates consistent command of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary² appropriate to the task. - illustrates consistent command of syntactic variety for meaning and reader interest. - utilizes appropriate and varied transitional words and phrases. - establishes and maintains a formal style and an objective tone.	The writing: - demonstrates consistent command of grade-level conventions of standard written English.³ - contains occasional minor and/or major errors, but the errors do not significantly interfere with meaning.
2	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - contains a limited introduction. - demonstrates an attempt to use organizational strategies to create some unification, but ideas may be hard to follow at times. - clarifies some relationships among ideas and concepts, but there are lapses in focus. - contains a limited concluding statement or section.	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - utilizes mostly relevant but insufficient evidence¹ from the stimuli to partially develop the topic. Some evidence may be inaccurate or repetitive. - explains some of the evidence provided, demonstrating only a partial understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli. There may be some level of inaccuracy in the explanation.	The writing: - illustrates inconsistent command of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.² - illustrates inconsistent command of syntactic variety. - utilizes basic or repetitive transitional words and phrases. - establishes but inconsistently maintains a formal style and an objective tone.	The writing: - demonstrates inconsistent command of grade-level conventions of standard written English.³ - contains frequent errors that may significantly interfere with meaning.
1	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - contains no or an irrelevant introduction. - demonstrates an unclear organizational structure; ideas are hard to follow most of the time. - fails to clarify relationships among ideas and concepts; concepts are unclear/or there is a lack of focus. - contains no or an irrelevant concluding statement or section.	In response to the task and the stimuli, the writing: - utilizes mostly irrelevant or no evidence¹ from the stimuli, or mostly/only personal knowledge, to inadequately develop the topic. Evidence is inaccurate or repetitive. - inadequately or inaccurately explains the evidence provided, demonstrating little understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.	The writing: - illustrates little to no use of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.² - illustrates little to no syntactic variety. - utilizes no or few transitional words and phrases. - does not establish or maintain a formal style and an objective tone.	The writing: - demonstrates limited command of grade-level conventions of standard written English.³ - contains numerous and repeated errors that seriously impede meaning.

¹Evidence includes facts, extended definitions, concrete details, quotations, or other information and examples as appropriate to the task and the stimuli.

² Domain-specific vocabulary refers to the terminology used in the stimuli and/or associated with the topic.

³ Conventions of standard written English include sentence structure, grammar, usage, spelling, capitalization, and punctuation.

If I had to lern somting new. i whud lern it then i whud go work out. to keep it in my mind. case in passage 1 pargaf 3 and 4. it sade that the pepol how work out. had a beetr test score. so that i culd get it stuk in my head. so that I wuld have a beetr test soce. in my nest test and culd study it. vary hard so that you get a 100# on a test in class nest time.and it will help you in the futer so i wuld do a work out to rimbr the tings I lern.in class.that day.and if you do not work out you will score lowre on your test and if cant work out you can just studey relly relly hard.to get a good test score in class.so you need to work out or studey hard.to get good test scores nest time100.

Focus & Organization: 1

Response contains a limited introduction (*If I had to lern somting new. i whud lern it then i whud go work out. to keep it in my mind.*) and an ineffective conclusion (*so you need to work out or studey hard.to get good test scores nest time100*). The writing demonstrates a confusing and unclear organizational structure and fails to clarify any relationship between ideas and concepts, demonstrating a complete lack of focus.

Development: 1

The response utilizes mostly irrelevant evidence from the stimuli (*passage 1 pargaf 3 and 4. it sade that the pepol how work out. had a beetr test score.*) and fails to develop the evidence that is presented, demonstrating little understanding of the task, topic, or stimuli.

Language: 1

The writing illustrates little use of precise language and no use of domain-specific vocabulary. It does not establish a formal style and has little syntactic variety. It uses only basic, repetitive transitions (*so*).

Conventions: 1

The response demonstrates very little command of grade-level conventions. Numerous and repeated sentence structure (fragments), spelling, and grammar errors and little control over end punctuation seriously impede meaning.

Here is why we need to stay fit becaues some people are pover to be repeating error and that no ok way need to sit up right on the bike and need to work out some people and they need to at least work out for 4 four hours and they long you do it is going to be easy and this oin ehy people today are sturring they don't work out and they need to so they stay for the video games and they never get uo study if you never get up and work out they get less barin space becaues you are so elvod with they game and if you do not they do not need to play vido game and that why some people cant remember thing like who you are imga a fake leg and you are critically and it is not going to move the same wayyour other hand doesit is going to be moving bck foward side ways

Focus & Organization: 1

There is an attempt at an introduction, (*Here is why we need to stay fit becaues some people are pover to be repeating error and that no ok*), but organizational structure is unclear and ideas are hard to follow. There is no conclusion.

Development: 1

No direct evidence from the stimuli is stated (although indirect references to bike riding, video game playing, and robotic appendages are mentioned). There is no development of any evidence.

Language: 1

The writing illustrates little use of precise language or domain-specific vocabulary. There is no syntactic variety because the writing consists of one long, single sentence, and there is little use of transitions (*and, becaues*).

Conventions: 1

Numerous grammar, spelling, and capitalization errors and a single sentence with no punctuation demonstrates little command over grade-level conventions and seriously impedes meaning.

You can learn something new while your off the couch by,for examlpe going outside and meeting people,going to the gym also meeting people there,working,being a uber driver,and many other things.

You can also go to the beach.But then you can also stay home play video games and meet people there...and make youtube videos and make money off of veiws and subs but also go out for a break.You can also go jogging for a block and jog back for a block.I dont know how exersising helps you remember stuff better but it sounds good!.

Focus & Organization: 1

The response contains an irrelevant introduction (*You can learn something new while your off the couch*) with no discernable organizational structure and ideas that are list like and hard to follow. The concluding statement (*I dont know how exersising helps you remember stuff better but it sounds good!*) is irrelevant.

Development: 1

No direct evidence from the passages is used. The personal knowledge that is provided is not explained, demonstrating little understanding of the task, topic, or stimuli.

Language: 1

The writing illustrates little use of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary and utilizes little syntactic variety with repetitive sentence structure (*You can learn, You can also go*). The response includes few transitions (*You can also*) and does not establish a formal style (*I dont know how exersising helps you remember stuff better but it sounds good!.*).

Conventions: 2

This response indicates inconsistent command of grade-level English. There are frequent errors in sentence structure, grammar/usage, and punctuation that interfere with meaning.

i could use this information to help me start exercising a little more. so then i could burn calories, and get more strenght. i really like how it said he combines engineering and technology to aid public health. i also like when he said when you try to correct on your next throw, it lands high. the thing were one group got a clockwise rotation, and the other group got a counterclockwise rotation that was very interesting. i love that they hit the target faster during the last set of counterclockwise rotation.

Focus & Organization: 1

The response contains an irrelevant introduction (*i could use this information to help me start exercising a little more*), and no conclusion; and its organizational strategy is simply a list of items that the writer likes.

Development: 1

The response utilizes mostly irrelevant evidence from the stimuli to inadequately develop the topic. It inadequately explains the relevance of the evidence provided (i.e., the writer “likes” some of the information from the passages but makes no attempt to explain why). The response demonstrates little understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 2

The writing illustrates an inconsistent command of precise language but does use some domain-specific vocabulary (*he combines engineering and technology to aid public health; one group got a clockwise rotation, and the other group got a counterclockwise rotation*). It also shows an inconsistent command of syntactic variety (*so then i could use this information to help me start exercising a little more; and, the thing were one group got a clockwise rotation, and the other group got a counterclockwise rotation that was very interesting*), and formal style.

Conventions: 2

The writing demonstrates inconsistent command of grade-level conventions of standard written English. There is an attempt at correct sentence structure and most spelling is correct. However, there are errors in capitalization, grammar/usage, and sentence structure (*the thing were one group got a clockwise rotation, and the other group got a counterclockwise rotation that was very interesting*) which interfere with meaning.

Did you know that exercise is a good thing and good portein for your brain? Exercising is a good thing for you and your body it gives you nuterients it also gets you hyped up.

"To Remember Something New Exercise" By Laura Sanders Exercising is good for you because you dont stay in the house all day it also helps you from getting fat cause when u sit around and eat juke you gain weight but if you dont you stay healthy and slim you got to get up and move around do thirdy one push ups each day and some jumping jacks curl ups all that.

"To Remember Something New Exercise" By Laura Sanders When you get portein you get more hyped you also get better sets of your workouts in sets in workouts means you have a certain daily workouts that you do each day thats what a set is for workouts best protien is a fruity smoothy or something healthy nothing greasey like burgers because then you will get a messed up stomach.

"To Remember Something New Exercise" By Laura Sanders You got to worry about the calories in stuff you eat because certain calories for certain wieght so if you go over you limit you lose muscle and gain fat when you get fat you get lazy you want to stay moving because if you get fat keep trying to get that muscle back.

Try not to get fat because when you get fat you being to waste time because you being lazy and not trying to exercise.

Focus & Organization: 2

The response contains a limited introduction (*Did you know that exercise is a good thing and good portein for your brain?*), an attempt to use organizational strategies to create some unification (three body paragraphs), and a limited concluding statement (*Try not to get fat because when you get fat you being to waste time because you being lazy and not trying to exercise*).

Development: 1

The response utilizes no relevant evidence from the stimuli except listing the name and author of Passage 1 to begin each body paragraph. No mention is made of Passage 2 and only personal knowledge/opinion is included. The response demonstrates little understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 2

The writing illustrates inconsistent command of language with an attempt at precise language (*best protien is a fruity smoothy or something healthy nothing greasey like burgers*) and no use of domain-specific vocabulary. Some language is repetitive and vague (*stuff you eat, gain fat when you get fat, you get lazy, you being lazy*). It has an inconsistent command of syntactic variety, and basic, repetitive transitions are used (*so, because*).

Conventions: 2

The writing illustrates inconsistent command of grade-level conventions. Although most spelling and capitalization is correct, and some correct end punctuation is used, there are errors in sentence structure (run-ons) and grammar which interfere with meaning.

"Hey you need to exercise before you do homework" my mom said. I never really understud why she made me burn off energy before i did my homework. I always thought it was that you needed to do your homework before you played. Although i thought about it even harder and relized that exercise before you do something important can help you be better at it. It can help you be better at the imprtance in 2 ways. One way is by getting your heart beating and ready to do the important thing that you have to do. Another way is by still staying healthy.

To get your heart beating you must have energy, if you dont have much energy then you will probably get tired and fall asleep while doing the important thing you need to do. Falling asleep while doing something important is a big deal because you could miss out on things that you need to know. Things that you need to know could include, times, schedules, dates, orders, rules, etc. That is why having energy can help with important things.

The last way to have energy before you do something important is beacause it helps ypu stay healthy. Staying healthy is very important to your body. If you are not as healthy as you can very easily die from not eatting properly. If you are not exercising or doing proper healthy activities it can relly effect your health and lifestyle.

Focus & Organization: 2

The response contains a limited introduction, demonstrates an attempt to use organizational strategies to create some unification (through use of the body paragraphs), clarifies some relationships among ideas but contains some gaps in focus, and has a limited concluding statement.

Development: 1

The response utilizes no evidence from the stimuli and inadequately explains the irrelevant evidence that is provided. The premise of the essay is to exercise before studying which runs contrary to the evidence in Passage 1, demonstrating little understanding of the task, topic, or stimuli.

Language: 2

The writing illustrates no use of domain-specific vocabulary, but some use of precise language (*I never really understud why she made me burn off energy before i did my homework. I always thought ... you needed to do your homework before you played; To get your heart beating you must have energy, if you dont have much energy then you will probably get tired and fall asleep while doing the important thing you need to do.*). The writing also shows an inconsistent command of syntactic variety and includes basic and repetitive transitional words and phrases (*One way, Another way, If you*). An inconsistent formal style is maintained (*"Hey you need to exercise before you do homework" my mom said. I never really understud why she made me burn off energy before i did my homework.*).

Conventions: 3

The writing demonstrates consistent command of grade-level conventions of standard written English. It contains occasional errors in capitalization (i) and spelling, but these errors do not significantly interfere with meaning.

Have you ever had a hard time trying to study? Many people feel the same way. They're are two and more ways to try. You can exercise after you study to bring back what you remember the things you study. The other one is mistakes you make a mistake you learn from them.

If you time the exercise right and you could boost your ability to remember something new. That's the finding of a new study. To lock up the new information, start burning those calories roughly four hours after you took in the new information. That's according to researchers at an institute on brain, cognition and behavior. That is why exercising helps people remember.

Your mistakes help you to remember what you're studying. Attempting a new task almost always involves trial and error. We pay attention to those errors. Our brains store memories of past blunders. We then use those memories to improve how well we do in the future attempts, a new study finds.

You can use both in your life. If you want to you can make your own. Or you can use more than those two. That could help you too it helps many people today. It is your choice you can choose either one.

Therefore, you can choose either one you like. There are more than two ways to do it. Many people use more than one. That is why you need to choose the one you're going to use. The reason people use them is because people have a hard time studying, like me.

Focus & Organization: 2

The response contains a limited introduction and conclusion. It demonstrates an attempt to use organizational strategies to create some unification by grouping ideas – exercise, trial and error, use in your life, clarifying some relationships among ideas.

Development: 2

The response utilizes mostly relevant but insufficient evidence from the stimuli to partially develop the topic (*To lock up the new information, start burning those calories roughly four hours after you took in the new information.... That is why exercising helps people remember*). The response explains some of the evidence provided, discussing at an inadequate level how exercise and trial and error aid recall, which demonstrates only a partial understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 2

The writing illustrates inconsistent command of language with attempts at domain-specific vocabulary (*You can exercise after you study to bring back what you remember*). It also shows an inconsistent command of syntactic variety with mostly simple sentences but attempts at more complex sentences (*If you time the exercise right and you could boost your ability to remember something new*). Some basic transitions are used (*The other one, If you, Therefore*). A large portion of this essay consists of paraphrased material from the stimulus, which limits the amount of original writing.

Conventions: 2

The writing illustrates inconsistent command of grade-level conventions. There is an attempt to use capitalization and punctuation correctly, but frequent errors in spelling, grammar, and usage (*fill* instead of *feel*, *help's* instead of *helps*, *therefour* interfere with meaning).

Both passages seemed to be very helpful. Passage 1 taught me that if you exercise it will help me remember something new. Passage 2 taught me that if you make mistakes it will help you for the next time around.

In passage one it tested two different therapies. The first one was exercising four hours before you took in new info. The second therapy was exercising four hours after taking in new info. Two days later they were tested on who knew the info better and the people that exercised four hours after had memorised the info better, so the second therapy was better.

In passage two they tested robotic arms. The first day they tested them and of course they made mistakes. The second time around they tested it again and they didn't make as many mistakes as they did the first time.

All in all, I loved both passages. They were both very informational. In personal preference I would use the passage 1 and their therapy.

Focus & Organization: 2

The response contains a limited introduction, demonstrates an attempt to use organizational strategies to create some unification through grouping of ideas (passage 1, passage 2) and has a limited concluding statement.

Development: 2

The response utilizes mostly relevant but insufficient evidence from the stimuli to partially develop the topic (*Passage 1 taught me that if you exercise it will help me remember something new. Passage 2 taught me that if you make mistakes it will help you for the next time around*). It explains some of the evidence provided, but there is some level of inaccuracy in the explanation (*passage one... tested two different therapies. The first one was exercising four hours before you took in new info. The second therapy was exercising four hours after taking in new info; ...In passage two they tested robotic arms*). The response demonstrates only a partial understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 2

The writing illustrates inconsistent command of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary. It utilizes basic transitional words and phrases (*first, second, All in all*). The response inconsistently maintains a formal style (*All in all, I loved both passages. They were both very informational. In personal preference I would use the passage 1 and their theory*).

Conventions: 2

The writing illustrates inconsistent command of grade-level conventions, containing frequent errors in spelling, grammar (changes in tense), punctuation (lack of appropriate commas), and usage (*new* for *knew*; *it* for *them*) which interfere with meaning.

Have you ever read the passages "To Remember Something New: Exercise!" or "Mistakes: A Key to Learning"? Well if you haven't i am going to give you some important information about those two passages.

First of all, about the Exercise passage you can learn alot of new things or remember something new. Also to lock up and remeber the new information, start burning calories roughly for four hours after you took in or learned the infomation. People think that the reason you can remember things better by exercising is because aerobic exercise sparks create several important chemicals in the brain like a protein known as BDNF, another is called dopamine, and also nerve and brain cells.

Next, I will talk about the mistakes passage and how mistakes are the key to learning. Some new studies find that our brains store memories of past blunders, and then use those memories to improve how well we do in future attempts. With each new attempt, the test participants correct their movements and accuracracy a bit.

Now, we are going to talk about both passages. So first we will talk about the Mistakes is the key to learning passage. Some new data also has shown that history determines whether our brains will learn from past errors when building new skills. So now next time you set out to try a new activity, be hold. Make mistakes and them it just may help you learn faster. So now about the pretty intresting Exercising passage. People did a four hour bike ride which led to more consistent activity in an area important for memory and that is also known as hippocampus. So its time to start exercising right, to boost your ability to remember something new!

In conclusion, thats some reasons why you should make mistakes to improve your memory and to exercise to burn calories and romember or learn somethong new. So i hope you learned something from this and can relize that making mistakes and exercising is a good thing to do, not just for your health, but for your brain.

Focus & Organization: 2

This response is organized as a five-paragraph essay, but both the introduction and the conclusion are limited. The body paragraphs, which attempt to use organizational strategies to create some unification, contain ideas that are sometimes hard to follow. This is particularly true of the last body paragraph which unsuccessfully attempts to connect the ideas discussed in the first two body paragraphs.

Development: 2

The response utilizes mostly relevant but insufficient evidence from the stimuli to partially develop the topic. It explains some of the evidence provided, but there is a level of inaccuracy in this explanation (*aerobic exercise sparks create several important chemicals in the brain like a protein known as BDNF, another is called dopamine, and also nerve and brain cells*). The response demonstrates only a partial understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 2

The writing illustrates inconsistent command of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary with much of the language lifted from the passages. It utilizes basic transitional

words and phrases (*First, Next, Now, so*). The response shows an inconsistent command of syntactic variety (*So first we will talk So now next time So its time to start*) and formal style (*Have you ever read the passages "To Remember Something New:Exercise!" or "Mistakes: A Key to Learning"? Well if you haven't i am going to give you some important information about those two passages.*).

Conventions: 3

The response demonstrates a consistent grade-level command of the conventions of standard written English. There are errors in spelling (*remeber, romember, accuracracy, be hold, intresting, relize*) and occasional minor errors in other conventions (missing apostrophes), but these errors do not significantly interfere with meaning.

Passage 1 gives reasons why you should exercise. Paragraph 1 says that if you go out and exercise it increases your ability to learn something new. If you go out in the sun you can get vitamin C from the sun. if you exercise everyday you can have a healthier life. Being on technology all day can mess up your vision. Riding a bike for 35 minutes is a workout because you are moving your legs alot. Thats why I think you should exercise.

Passage 2 gives talks about if our brains save all of the mistakes we have made in our life. Remembering your mistakes is a good thing because you can learn from them. Mistakes can get you somewhere in life like graduating school or getting a job. Mistakes show that you are trying to accomplish something. paragraph 6 says Attempting a new task always involves trial and errors. Thats why I think that remembering mistakes is a good thing.

Those are the reasons that exercising and remembering mistakes is good because both make a difference in life. By exercising you exercise your brain so it would be easier to remember your mistakes. So try working out and trying to remember your mistakes because everyone has mistakes.

Focus & Organization: 2

The response has no introduction but it contains a relevant concluding section. It attempts an organizational strategy by organizing related ideas into paragraphs (passage 1, passage 2), but ideas are difficult to follow at times and there are lapses in focus.

Development: 2

The response utilizes mostly relevant but insufficient evidence from the stimuli to partially develop the topic. It explains some of the evidence provided demonstrating only a partial understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 3

The writing illustrates consistent command of precise language (*If you go out in the sun you can get vitamin C from the sun. if you exercise everyday you can have a healthier life. . . . Mistakes can get you somewhere in life like graduating school or getting a job*). It illustrates consistent command of syntactic variety with a mix of simple and complex sentences. The writing establishes and maintains a formal style.

Conventions: 3

The response demonstrates a consistent command of grade-level conventions of standard written English. There are occasional minor errors, but they do not significantly interfere with meaning.

People make mistakes, and some people learn from those mistakes. Mistakes can be corrected based on memories of past errors. Scientists have studied how people can problem-solve based on memories of mistakes they had made in the past....

The timing is very important. According to the text *To Remember Something New: Exercise!*, "Those who remembered the objects' sites best were the people who had waited four hours after their learning session before pedaling away. So, when a person makes a mistake, they normally don't learn about it right away. But, if they wait a certain amount of time, then the person will realize their mistake, and then try to correct and learn from it....

Scientists have been studying how the person remembers the errors they make. Just like the timing, it helps on how the average person repeats the error they made and realize what they've been doing wrong, so they try to find a different technique. Sometimes, they'll be drawn to another mistake and the cycle will continue. According to the text *Mistakes: A key to learning*, "Herzfeld wanted to know what would happen then - could the brain recall the earlier low throw and correct the error?"

In conclusion, the average person can learn from their mistakes and errors, whether it is at a computer game or a question on the test. If you ever find yourself making a mistake, don't give up! Find new ways to solve your problem....

Focus & Organization: 3

The response has an adequate organizational structure with a relevant introduction and conclusion. It is organized into logical paragraphs (timing, errors). The writing clarifies most relationships between ideas and concepts (*Just like the timing, it helps how the average person repeats the error. . .*).

Development: 2

The response utilizes mostly relevant but insufficient evidence from the stimuli to only partially develop the topic. It explains some of the evidence provided, but there is a level of inaccuracy in this explanation (*when a person makes a mistake, they normally don't learn about it right away. But, if they wait a certain amount of time, then the person will realize their mistake, and then try to correct and learn from it*), demonstrating only a partial understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 3

The writing illustrates the consistent use of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary and demonstrates the use of syntactic variety and appropriate transitional phrases. A formal style is maintained.

Conventions: 3

The response demonstrates a consistent command of grade-level conventions of standard written English. There are occasional minor errors, but they do not significantly interfere with meaning.

Did you know that exercise can help keep our memories in top shape. I got that fact from an excerpt from "To Remember Something New: Exercise!" and a excerpt from "Mistakes: a key to learning,"and by using those pasages I will inform you on the best way to learn something and remember it. I know that you must learn by making mistakes,using trial and error, and exercising.

To learn or even perfect something you must make mistakes. For example, " Our brains store memories of past blunders. We then use those memories to improve how well we do in future attempts"(Alison Pearce Stevens). using our failures as a stepping stool can improve a person, with out learning from our mistakes we still may be at a primal level, but failing lets us improve and grow. Overall, humans learn from making mistakes.

To solve a problem trial and error is a good way to figure it out. In particular, " Attempting a new task almost always involves trial and error" (Alison Pearce Stevens). To use trial and error is to figure out what does not and what works then use what you know to answer that problem, trial and error can be used on any problem because there is always a choice to what you do. Ultimately, to learn easier use trial and error.

To keep something in mind after learning it you should exercise. According to the text, "To look up new information, start burning those calories roughly four hours after you took in the new information" (Laura Sanders). if exerciseing can help memory than thats an excuse to work hard, plenty of people do so you should to because hard work is what is needed to make the human race more advanced and more amazing, so remembering what you learn is esential for you to help build the future. Altogether, exerciseing can help you remember what you learn.

To learn something new you should slip up, use trial and error, and build up a sweat. Learning is the most important thing to the human race without learning we couldn't advance to what we are today. If even exercising can help you learn something then I advise you buy a bike.

Focus & Organization: 3

The writing has a clear organizational structure with a relevant introduction and conclusion. It is organized into three logical body paragraphs that explain the points made in the introduction (*I know that you must learn by making mistakes,using trial and error, and exercising.*) and clarify relationships between these ideas. The response reads as a cohesive whole.

Development: 3

Evidence is relevant and sufficient to adequately develop the topic. Explanation of evidence demonstrates a sufficient understanding of the task and stimuli. For example, the writer follows an appropriate quote from Passage 2 with a relevant explanation (*using our failures as a stepping stool can improve a person, with out learning from our mistakes we still may be at a primal level, but failing lets us improve and grow. Overall, humans learn from making mistakes*). The response demonstrates a sufficient understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 3

The writing shows a consistent command of grade-level written English and mostly retains a formal tone. Vocabulary is appropriate to the task, and some sentence variety is shown. Appropriate transitional words and phrases are used (*by using those passages; overall; to solve a problem; to use trial and error; to keep something in mind*).

Conventions: 3

The response demonstrates a consistent grade-level command of the conventions of written English. There are spelling errors, a missing capital (*i*), a missing apostrophe (*that's*), and comma splices , but they do not significantly interfere with meaning.

Did you know that you can learn something new everyday? Well, Researchers from the passages "To Remember Something New:Exercise" by Laura Sanders and "Mistakes are the key to learning" by Alison Pearce Stevens, show that there are different ways to learn new things in lots of ways. From learning new things by exercising to learning new things by making mistakes.

First off, exercising is one way to learn new information. For example, in "To Remember Something New:Exercise" the author talks about how Eelco and his team of researchers discovered if you exercise after you study or learn something new you will be able to remember it better, therefore learning it and not forgetting. In the text the author writes says "Two days later they were tested again. Those who remembered the objects' sites best were the people who had waited four hours after their learning session before pedaling away," This quote shows that exercising four hours after learning improves your memory. This quote is important and relates to my claim because it shows that exercising is one way that you can learn something new.

In addition, you can learn something new by making mistakes and learning from them. For example, in "Mistakes: A key to learning" David Herzfeld's study shows that through trial and error you can learn new things. In the text "Mistakes: Akey to learning" the author states "Herzfeld found that both groups hit the target faster during the last set of counterclockwise rotations. ... and they had "saved" memories of their errors, now using them to make the proper corrections... that happens when we remember errors from one situation and apply them to a different one." This quote shows that your brain and yourself can learn new things by making a mistake and then your brain corrects it." This quote is important and relates to my claim because it shows that when we make a mistake and then later encounter another difficult situation our brain will apply what we previously learned to the new situation.

In conclusion, there are lots of ways to learn new things and two of them are exercising after a study session and through making mistakes and correcting them in trial and error situations. So next time you wish you could remember information for a test or want to have better memory, exercise after you study or do a really hard worksheet related to what your doing to help your brain correct your mistakes.

Focus & Organization: 3

The response utilizes an adequate organizational strategy, creating a mostly unified whole with ideas logically grouped into paragraphs (*exercising is one way to learn new information, you can learn something new by making mistakes*). The introduction and conclusion are relevant to the task.

Development: 3

Evidence is relevant and sufficient to adequately develop the topic. Explanation of evidence demonstrates a sufficient understanding of the task and stimuli. The response directly addresses the prompt by "*explaining how you could use the information in both passages to learn something new.*" The response demonstrates a sufficient understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 3

The writing shows a consistent command of precise and domain specific language (*encounter another difficult situation, study session, worksheet*), and retains a formal tone. Some sentence variety is shown with a mix of simple and complex sentences. Appropriate and varied transitional words and phrases are used (*First off, For example, In the next text, In addition, This quote shows*).

Conventions: 3

The response demonstrates a consistent grade-level command of the conventions of written English. There are spelling (*aply, trail*) , grammar/usage errors (*do a really had worksheet related to what your doing to help*), but they do not significantly interfere with meaning.

If you make mistakes you will learn from them the next time. For example in the second passage they had people play a video game. When they did they would improve their scores the second time. Also when people take a test and then wait four hours before exercising they improve their scores the next time they take it.

In this passage I am going to be explaining to you how you learn from your mistakes. David Herzfeld gave two different sets of people a video game. In one the robot moved counterclockwise and in the other they moved clockwise. The people that would mess up would soon learn from their mistakes. Later he gave both people a video game where the robot moved counterclockwise and the people that already had counterclockwise improved but the people that had clockwise also improved. The way the group that did not have the same one improved was by meta-learning.

The other thing they learned that was if you did exercise four hours after you did your test you memorized it better. For example, they gave people a test they made some watched relaxing nature videos but they didn't improve. They had others exercise as soon as they got done but they did not improve either. The last group of people they had wait four hours before exercising and they improved. So exercising helps you keep your memory.

They both have helped scientist in many different ways. Both of these two new learnings helps us know that we can learn from our mistakes. They also taught us that we can exercise and it helps our memory. Would you have ever thought that by exercising you could improve your memory? Have you ever thought that you could learn about your mistakes?

So the research that both of these people had done has improved the way scientist think and it has also taught us that it is okay to make mistakes you learn from them. It has also taught us that exercising has improved our memory. So if you ever make a mistake just remember to learn from them next time.

Focus & Organization: 3

There is cohesive organization and focus throughout this essay. It contains a relevant introduction. The first two body paragraphs adequately address the points made in the introduction. The final body paragraph and relevant conclusion repeat the points made.

Development: 3

Evidence is relevant and sufficient to adequately develop the topic (*David Herzfeld gave two different sets of people a video game. In one the robot moved counterclockwise and in the other they moved clockwise.*). Explanation of evidence demonstrates a sufficient understanding of the task and stimuli (*They both have helped scientist in many different ways. Both of these two new learnings helps us know that we can learn from our mistakes. They also taught us that we can exercise and it helps our memory.*).

Language: 3

The writing shows a consistent command of grade-level precise language and domain-specific vocabulary (*Later he gave both people a video game where the robot moved counterclockwise*). Some syntactic variety is shown, and appropriate transitional words and

phrases are used (*For example, Also, In this passage, Later, The other thing, Both of these, They also*). The writing demonstrates a formal tone.

Conventions: 4

The writing demonstrates consistent and sophisticated command of grade-level conventions. The few minor errors (missing commas) do not interfere with the meaning of the response.

You could use these two texts to learn new and important information about how the brain uses memory. Passage 1 talks about how it's proven that if you exercise about four hours after learning or studying then you have a better chance of remembering what you learned. Passage 2 tells us about David Herzfeld finding a new type of memory and then tells us more about this type of memory.

Both of these texts have important information in them that tell us about memory and how our brains work. For example in passage 1 it says, "Time the exercise right and you could boost your ability to remember something new. That's the finding of a new study." This excerpt from the passage tells us about exercising and how it can help us remember newly learned things easier. Where as passage 2 talks about a newly found type of memory, which was found by David Herzfeld. In the second passage, it says in paragraph 6, "Our brains store memories of past blunders. We then use those memories to improve how well we do in future attempts, a new study finds." Then in paragraph 7 it says, "David Herzfeld discovered this newly identified type of memory." Therefore, both texts give us information about how we use memory or how memory can be remembered better.

In passage 1 it focuses more on how memory can be saved and used to it's full potential or close. It says in paragraph 4, "Two days later they were tested again. Those who remembered the objects' sites best were the people who had waited four hours after their learning session before pedaling away." This goes to show you that working out a few hours after learning something important will help you remember it. Scientist that ran this test still don't know how exercise helps you with your memory, but it does, and they have an idea why. It tells us this in paragraph 5, "Van Dongen's team does not yet know how exercise works its memory magic. They do, however, have a guess. Aerobic exercise sparks the creation of several important chemicals in the brain. One is a protein known as BDNF. The other is dopamine. It can help relay messages between nerve cells."

The second passage, however, talks about the type of memory that was recently identified by David Herzfeld. Herzfeld thinks that by making mistakes and remembering them, that you will learn from them and it will help you in the future. In this passage it states, "It's an exciting find says Farrel Robinson. He's a neuroscientist at the University of Washington in Seattle and not involved in the research. This study is the first to show that the history of mistakes is what matters in the mortor learning, he says." This shows that other people that are not at all involved in the study stillll find this as an exciting find for many reasons. At the very end of this passage it also says, "So the next time you set out to try a new activity, be bold. Make mistakes. They just may help you learn faster." This is an encouraging excerpt from the passage but according to the previous information in this passage it is an accurate statement.

As you can see now both passages give us helpful information about memory. Passage one and two had different topics, but both gave important information when it comes to learning about memory and researching it as well. Even as a student you could use this information, therefore the information given in borh passages were extremely important.

Focus & Organization: 4

The response utilizes an effective organizational strategy and contains an effective and relevant introduction and conclusion. It is organized into logical paragraphs that create a unified whole. The body paragraphs effectively clarify relationships between ideas and concepts.

Development: 4

Well chosen, relevant and sufficient evidence from the stimuli is utilized to effectively develop the topic. Explanation of evidence demonstrates a thorough understanding of the task and stimuli. The response explains the overarching purpose of each passage and then explains specific evidence from each passage. The response demonstrates a sophisticated and clear understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 4

The writing illustrates a consistent and sophisticated command of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary (*Both of these texts have important information in them that tell us about memory and how our brains work.... Herzfeld thinks that by making mistakes and remembering them, that you will learn from them and it will help you in the future.*). The writing also illustrates sophisticated command of syntactic variety and effectively establishes and maintains a formal style and an objective tone.

Conventions: 4

The writing demonstrates consistent and sophisticated command of grade-level conventions. The few spelling errors and usage error (*it's*) do not interfere with the meaning of the response.

Today, the topic at hand is on learning. In these two passages, the authors introduce new ideas on learning: how it can be improved by exercise and how errors can benefit the learning process. One could use the information provided in these passages to help themselves in their own studies.

In the first passage, the author uses scientific research to prove that exercise after a certain period of time can help you to remember things you have learned. In this study, carried out by Eelco van Dongen and his colleagues at Radboud University's Medical Center, in Nijmegen, the Netherlands, the seventy-two participants were shown the location of ninety different objects on a computer screen. After this, the participants either watched soothing nature videos or exercised on stationary bikes, alternating between strenuous and relaxed pedaling for a thirty-five minute period. The key variable here is when these people did these activities: either soon after they learned this information or four hours later. After two days, the recruits were once again tested. These results showed that the people who waited for hours and then exercised remembered the location of these objects better. You could use the information provided to help yourself! After coming home from a long day of learning at school or work, get a little exercise. This study proves that doing this will help you in the long run, and doing so could make you feel as though that science test you've been dreading might be a little easier than you thought.

In the second passage, another study is quoted. This study, performed by David Herzfield, a biomedical engineer at John Hopkins University School of Medicine in Baltimore, suggests that our brains pay attention to errors when we try new things, store them in a vault, perhaps, and use them when we are faced with an activity like the original one to help us avoid making the same mistake again. Dr. Herzfield performed this study by asking others to play a simple video game. This video game included moving a robotic arm across the screen using the cursor. Easy enough, right? There is one more very important variable in this equation. The robotic arm and the person's hand were shielded from their view. The amount that the cursor moved with the arm and the arm moved with the cursor varied on occasion. The testees got used to these differentials, and remembered them when they occurred at the same time in the rotation. But do our brains save the errors? To discover this, Herzfield ran another set of tests. This time, when the player went to move the arm, it rotated thirty degrees. One group of testees experienced a clockwise rotation, while the other experienced a counterclockwise rotation, followed by a second phase with no rotation. In the final phase, the arm moved counterclockwise for both groups. The result of this test was surprising: in the final phase, both groups reached the target faster. The surprise was not with the group that had experienced the counterclockwise rotation in the first phase, but with the second group. Herzfield found that the clockwise group's time finding the target also improved. He called it meta-learning, which happens when your brain takes errors from one situation and applies them to another. So in this way, your brain could be helping you without you even knowing it! This passage proves that it is okay to make mistakes. They can even help you learn. This can be of great aid when trying something new. You might have that information stored away, and already know how to do this activity.

In short, these two passages give great ways to help you learn. Whether you are a kid or an adult, this information can help you out in the long run. Add some spice to your life, get up and exercise after you learn or don't be scared to try new things. So after you read that science chapter

or that giant book, wait awhile, then get some excersise. It will help you remember the things you learned. Also, never feel afraid to make mistakes. If you continue practise these things, you won't keep making the same mistakes. Do these things, and maybe you won't bring home that D on your report card or never get better at ping-pong. You'll never know until you try!

Focus & Organization: 4

The response includes an effective introduction and conclusion. An effective organizational strategy is utilized creating cohesion and a unified whole. Each body paragraph is focused on a passage, with clear connections between ideas (*After coming home from a long day of learning at school or work, get a little excersise. This study proves that doing this will help you in the long run, and doing so could make you feel as though that science test you've been dreading might be a little easier than you thought.*).

Development: 4

Well chosen, relevant and sufficient evidence from the stimuli is utilized to effectively develop the topic. Explanation of this evidence demonstrates a thorough understanding of the task and stimuli (*The key variable here is when these people did these activities: either soon after they learned this information or four hours later. . . . This passage proves that it is okay to make mistakes. They can even help you learn. This can be of great aid when trying something new. You might have that information stored away, and already know how to do this activity.*). The response demonstrates an insightful and clear understanding of the topic, task, and stimuli.

Language: 4

The writing illustrates a consistent and sophisticated command of precise language and domain-specific vocabulary (*The amount that the cursor moved with the arm and the arm moved with the cursor varied on occasion. The testees got used to these differentials, and remembered them when they occured at the same time in the rotation.*). The writing also illustrates sophisticated command of syntactic variety (mix of simple, complex, and compound sentences) and effectively establishes and maintains a formal style and an objective tone throughout.

Conventions: 4

The writing demonstrates consistent and sophisticated command of grade-level conventions, particularly in sentence structure. The few spelling errors do not interfere with meaning.